SHAPING TOMORROW
DECISION INTELLIGENCE

US and UK stablecoin rulebooks harden as the digital euro clears Parliament

This cycle's money-and-payments momentum turns on regulation: the US GENIUS Act rulebook nears its deadline, the Bank of England sets out a systemic stablecoin regime, and the European Parliament clears the digital euro for final talks.

Edition 3 · previous cycle: 'Bank clearing layer for tokenised deposits arrives as the digital euro nears a vote' (18 June 2026)

Money's plumbing rarely moves on one clock, but this cycle three regulatory clocks struck together. In the United States, agencies are racing the GENIUS Act's final-rule deadline; the Bank of England published its systemic stablecoin regime (Bank of England, June 2026); and the European Parliament secured its negotiating mandate for a digital euro (Brussels Signal, July 2026). The sharpest movements since last cycle are the digital euro, which advanced from committee preparation to a plenary mandate, and the deposit-drain debate, which shifted from stable to accelerating as the IMF (IMF, April 2026) and a record market cap pushed it back onto agendas. The question boards now hold: whose money settles the tokenised economy, and under whose rules?

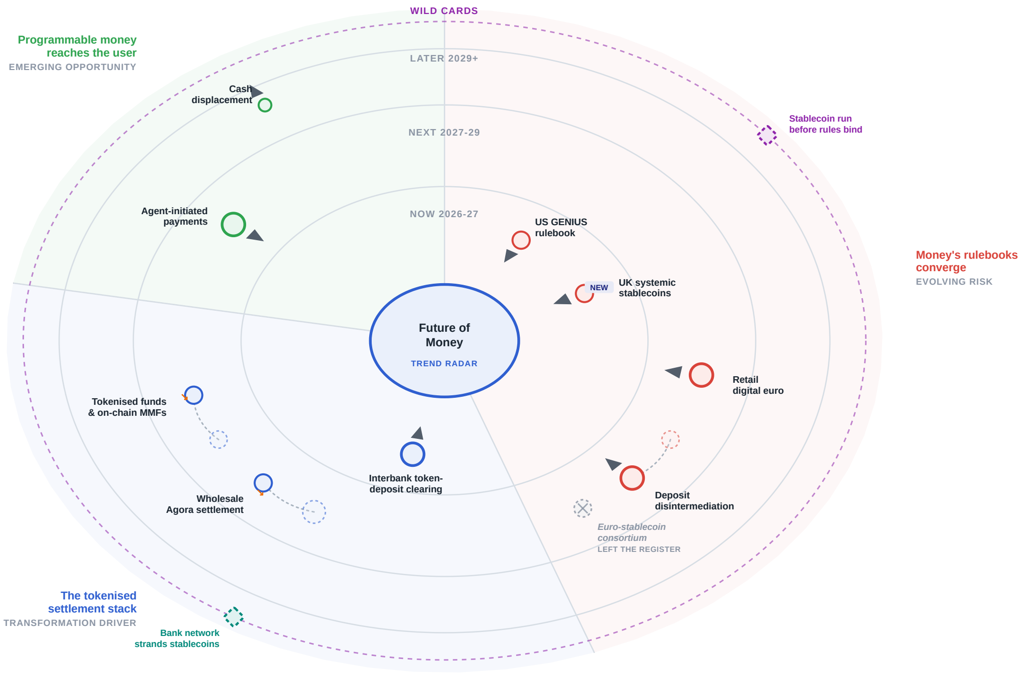
Trend Radar

The momentum register mapped onto the horizon: ring = when a trend bites, sector = the cycle's pattern cluster, blip size = heat, arrows = momentum, dashed ghosts and tails = drift since the 18 June register. Hover any blip for its full entry; expand for the reading view.

MOMENTUM THIS CYCLE 6 Accelerating 2 Stable 1 Fading

· 1 new to the register · 2 cooled a stage · 1 left the register evolving risk · transformation driver · emerging opportunity · wild card · heat: cool → very hot

▲ toward centre = accelerating · ▽ outward = fading · drift tail = last cycle's state · ✕ left the register



How to read this radar

Rings are time. Now 2026-27 · Next 2027-29 · Later 2029+. The closer to the centre, the sooner it bites.

Sectors are the cycle's patterns. Red = evolving risk, blue = transformation driver, green = emerging opportunity, the same palette as our Futures Wheel.

Size is heat. Bigger blips carry higher impact × likelihood in the momentum table.

▲ **Arrows are momentum.** Pointing toward the centre = accelerating; outward = fading. No arrow = stable.

Dashed ghosts are last cycle. The dotted tail shows the drift since the 30 May register.

Diamonds on the outer rim are wild cards, low-probability, high-impact discontinuities, each with its tripwires.

Hover any blip for its full register entry, and click to pin it. This guide returns when you move away, or press ? any time.

Momentum across the topic

Trend	Cluster	Horizon	Heat	Momentum	Evidence
US stablecoin rulemaking machinery	EVOLVING RISK	2026-2027	MODERATE	ACCELERATING	OCC and Treasury proposals put the GENIUS rulebook near its statutory final-rule deadline (OCC, February 2026).
UK systemic stablecoin regime NEW	EVOLVING RISK	2026-2027	MODERATE	ACCELERATING	The Bank of England eased backing to 70% government debt and set a 40bn pound issuance guardrail (Bank of England, June 2026).
Retail digital euro	EVOLVING RISK	2027-2029	HOT	ACCELERATING	Parliament backed the digital-euro mandate 416 to 169, opening trilogues (Brussels Signal, July 2026).

Trend	Cluster	Horizon	Heat	Momentum	Evidence
Stablecoin deposit disintermediation	EVOLVING RISK	2026-2031	HOT	ACCELERATING	Deposit-drain concern returned to accelerating as the IMF flagged stablecoin run risk against a record 315bn dollar market cap (IMF, April 2026).
Interbank tokenised-deposit clearing layer	TRANSFORMATION DRIVER	2026-2028	HOT	ACCELERATING	The Clearing House will settle tokenised deposits on-chain across the largest US banks, targeting H1 2027 (ABA Banking Journal, June 2026).
Wholesale cross-border tokenised settlement ↘	TRANSFORMATION DRIVER	2026-2030	MODERATE	STABLE	Project Agora reached atomic settlement across seven jurisdictions and moved to real-value testing (BIS, May 2026).

Trend	Cluster	Horizon	Heat	Momentum	Evidence
Tokenised funds and on-chain MMFs ↘	TRANSFORMATION DRIVER	2026-2030	MODERATE	STABLE	Tokenised real-world assets neared 34bn dollars, led by Treasuries and BlackRock BUIDL (crypto.news, May 2026).
Agent-initiated machine payments	EMERGING OPPORTUNITY	2026-2030	HOT	ACCELERATING	Mastercard opened card rails to machine payments with more than 30 partners and multi-rail settlement (CoinDesk, June 2026).
Cash displacement	EMERGING OPPORTUNITY	2026-2035	COOL	FADING	Cash keeps ceding ground slowly as the EU legislates guaranteed access (Brussels Signal, July 2026).

Trend	Cluster	Horizon	Heat	Momentum	Evidence
A systemic stablecoin run before the rulebooks bind	DISRUPTIVE RISK	Wild-card rim	VERY HIGH	–	A large issuer depegs while the final GENIUS and UK rules are still in the comment phase (Change Tracker, 16 July 2026).
A bank-run tokenised-deposit network strands non-bank stablecoins	DISRUPTIVE OPPORTUNITY	Wild-card rim	HIGH	–	The Clearing House network scales fast enough to make bank tokens the default settlement asset (Change Tracker, 16 July 2026).

Trend	Cluster	Horizon	Heat	Momentum	Evidence
European bank euro-stablecoin consortium (Qivalis)	LEFT THE REGISTER	–	WAS MODERATE	–	Carried in the 18 June register (Moderate heat, Accelerating; a widening bank group backing Qivalis toward a late-2026 euro stablecoin). Not carried in the 16 July register: watch for re-entry as the UK and EU rulebooks settle the perimeter it would issue into.

Ring = when the trend bites (Now 2026-27 · Next 2027-29 · Later 2029+), sector = pattern cluster, blip size and stroke = heat (impact × likelihood), arrows = momentum direction this cycle. Wild cards sit on the dashed outer rim. **Drift tails** show movement against the 18 June register: a dashed ghost is the trend's previous state, the dotted tail leads to where it sits now, and a grey crossed ghost marks a trend carried last cycle but absent from this one. Trends with no tail held their grades.

Pattern narrative

Money's rulebooks converge as the deposit question stays open EVOLVING RISK

Three signals sit in one uneasy pattern. US agencies are finalising GENIUS Act stablecoin rules against a statutory deadline (U.S. Treasury, April 2026), the Bank of England published a systemic sterling-stablecoin regime, and the deposit-drain debate returned. The rulebooks are deliberately enabling. Yet the IMF restated that unregulated stablecoins are run-prone (IMF, April 2026), and a record $315 billion market cap (Crypto Briefing, July 2026) revived the question of whether tokens pull funding from banks, which the evidence still cannot settle.

The tokenised settlement stack reaches tested infrastructure

TRANSFORMATION DRIVER

The settlement stack is the cycle's quiet driver. The Clearing House will clear tokenised deposits between the largest US banks (ABA Banking Journal, June 2026), Project Agora proved atomic cross-border settlement and moved to real-value testing (BIS, May 2026), and tokenised funds reached roughly $34 billion (crypto.news, May 2026). Two cooled from accelerating to stable this cycle: the build is real but no fresh inflection landed. The open question is whether settlement stays anchored in central-bank and commercial-bank money.

Programmable and sovereign money advance to the user

EMERGING OPPORTUNITY

On the user side, public and private programmable money advanced together inside the regulated perimeter. The digital euro cleared Parliament with holding caps to protect bank deposits and bank distribution (Brussels Signal, July 2026), while Mastercard opened compliant, multi-rail agent payments (CoinDesk, June 2026). Cash keeps declining slowly as the EU legislates guaranteed access. The near-term change is supervised money reaching new payment surfaces.

Signals gaining momentum

1. **US stablecoin rulemaking machinery.** A published final rule, or a missed deadline, forces issuers and banks to commit to a compliance architecture.
2. **Retail digital euro.** A trilogue deal by year-end converts a mandate into a dated build for card networks and banks.
3. **UK systemic stablecoin regime.** Finalising the Code of Practice after September feedback sets a live sterling-stablecoin perimeter.
4. **Interbank tokenised-deposit clearing layer.** A firm launch date makes banks choose between the shared network and proprietary tokens.
5. **Stablecoin deposit disintermediation.** Confirmed outflow evidence in one banking system moves this from debate to balance-sheet planning.

Wild Cards to Watch

A systemic stablecoin run before the rulebooks bind

DISRUPTIVE RISK *Potential impact: Very High*

Surprise characteristics: A large issuer depegs while the final GENIUS and UK rules are still in the comment phase.

Early warning indicators: Redemption spikes; thinner reserve disclosure; widening secondary-market discounts.

The IMF restated that unregulated stablecoins are run-prone (IMF, April 2026) even as the market cap set records (Crypto Briefing, July 2026). A depeg in the gap before final rules bind would be the pattern's stress test.

A bank-run tokenised-deposit network strands non-bank stablecoins

DISRUPTIVE OPPORTUNITY *Potential impact: High*

Surprise characteristics: The Clearing House network scales fast enough to make bank tokens the default settlement asset.

Early warning indicators: A named launch date; RTP and CHIPS throughput; early corporate-treasury adoption.

The Clearing House will settle tokenised deposits on-chain across the largest US banks, targeting H1 2027 (ABA Banking Journal, June 2026). If it scales ahead of schedule, the settlement default flips to bank money.

Implications

For treasury, payments and custody teams, this is a cycle to prepare rather than commit. The US and UK rulebooks are now close enough that issuer, custody and reserve requirements are plannable, so mapping exposure to both regimes is worth doing before final rules land. The tokenised-settlement stack warrants a watching brief and a pilot budget, since the choice between bank tokenised deposits, non-bank stablecoins and wholesale central-bank rails will shape counterparty and liquidity risk. The digital euro becomes a decision point for card-dependent businesses if trilogues conclude by year-end. Deposit drain, on the evidence here, is worth monitoring closely rather than acting on.

Bibliography

Source tiers: **Tier 1**, governments, regulators and intergovernmental bodies. **Tier 2**, think-tanks, academic institutes, major consultancies and quality data providers. **Tier 3**, quality journalism and specialist trade press. **Tier 4**, vendor, company and practitioner sources, used only as directional corroboration.

- **Tier 1** OCC proposed rule to implement the GENIUS Act. Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (25/02/2026).
- **Tier 1** Treasury proposes AML and sanctions rule to implement the GENIUS Act. U.S. Department of the Treasury (08/04/2026).
- **Tier 1** Policy statement and draft rules on systemic stablecoins. Bank of England (22/06/2026).
- **Tier 1** Project Agora: tokenisation for wholesale cross-border payments advances to real-value testing. Bank for International Settlements (27/05/2026).
- **Tier 2** Making Stablecoins Stable (Working Paper 2026/074). International Monetary Fund (10/04/2026).
- **Tier 3** The Clearing House to launch tokenized deposits system. ABA Banking Journal (05/06/2026).
- **Tier 3** Tokenized real-world assets triple to $34 billion. crypto.news (25/05/2026).
- **Tier 3** Mastercard prepares agentic commerce platform for AI-agent payments. CoinDesk (10/06/2026).
- **Tier 3** Parliament clears digital euro talks after right-wing groups force a vote. Brussels Signal (10/07/2026).

- Tier 3 European Parliament backs digital euro to reduce US payment dominance. Euronews (23/06/2026).
- Tier 3 Circle's USDC drives record stablecoin volume in June 2026. Crypto Briefing (06/07/2026).
- Tier 4 Mastercard launches Agent Pay for Machines. Mastercard (10/06/2026).

Prepared by Shaping Tomorrow: 16 July 2026